

With writing on wall, Wray says he'll quit FBI post

Trump had already said he would replace director

By Adam Goldman and Devlin Barrett
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — FBI Director Christopher Wray said Wednesday that he intends to resign before the Trump administration takes office, bowing to the reality that President-elect Donald Trump had publicly declared his desire to replace him.

Wray announced the move while addressing employees Wednesday afternoon in remarks that tacitly acknowledged the politically charged position the FBI now faces with an incoming president who openly scorns the agency.

“I’ve decided the right thing for the bureau is for me to serve until the end of the current administration in January and then step down,” Wray said. “This is the best way to avoid dragging the bureau deeper into the fray, while reinforcing the values and principles that are so important to how we do our work.”

The director spoke wistfully about his time at the FBI. “This is not easy for me,” he said, addressing a packed conference room at FBI headquarters, as many more watched on video feeds at FBI offices around the country. “I love this place, I love our mission, and I love our people.” He left the room to a standing ovation, and some shed tears as Wray shook employees’ hands on the way out, according to an FBI official.

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Kennedy’s deal with Libertarians on fund-raising brings questions

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Amid a floundering independent run for president this summer, Robert F. Kennedy Jr. quietly inked a fund-raising agreement that allowed him to ask supporters for bigger donations. The deal was lucrative — but not just for Kennedy’s campaign. It also ended up being a boon for some of his political opponents and even an obscure Massachusetts political group.

The agreement, called a joint fund-raising committee, was set up with the Libertarian National Committee to bolster the Kennedy campaign. But Kennedy was never on the Libertarian ticket; he ran a rival independent campaign. In fact, after he dropped out of the race, most of the money went into supporting Donald Trump.

That type of committee is a common setup for major political party candidates. In theory, the contract allows a party and its corresponding candidate, PACs, and state parties to fund-raise together, allowing donors to write one large check for the maximum amount to all of them combined, rather than just the \$6,600 limit to a single

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Still smarting over rates, mayor and council look ahead

By Niki Griswold and Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

After months of trying to minimize the hit to homeowners, the City of Boston on Wednesday set new property tax rates that will increase taxes on single family homes by more than 10 percent on average.

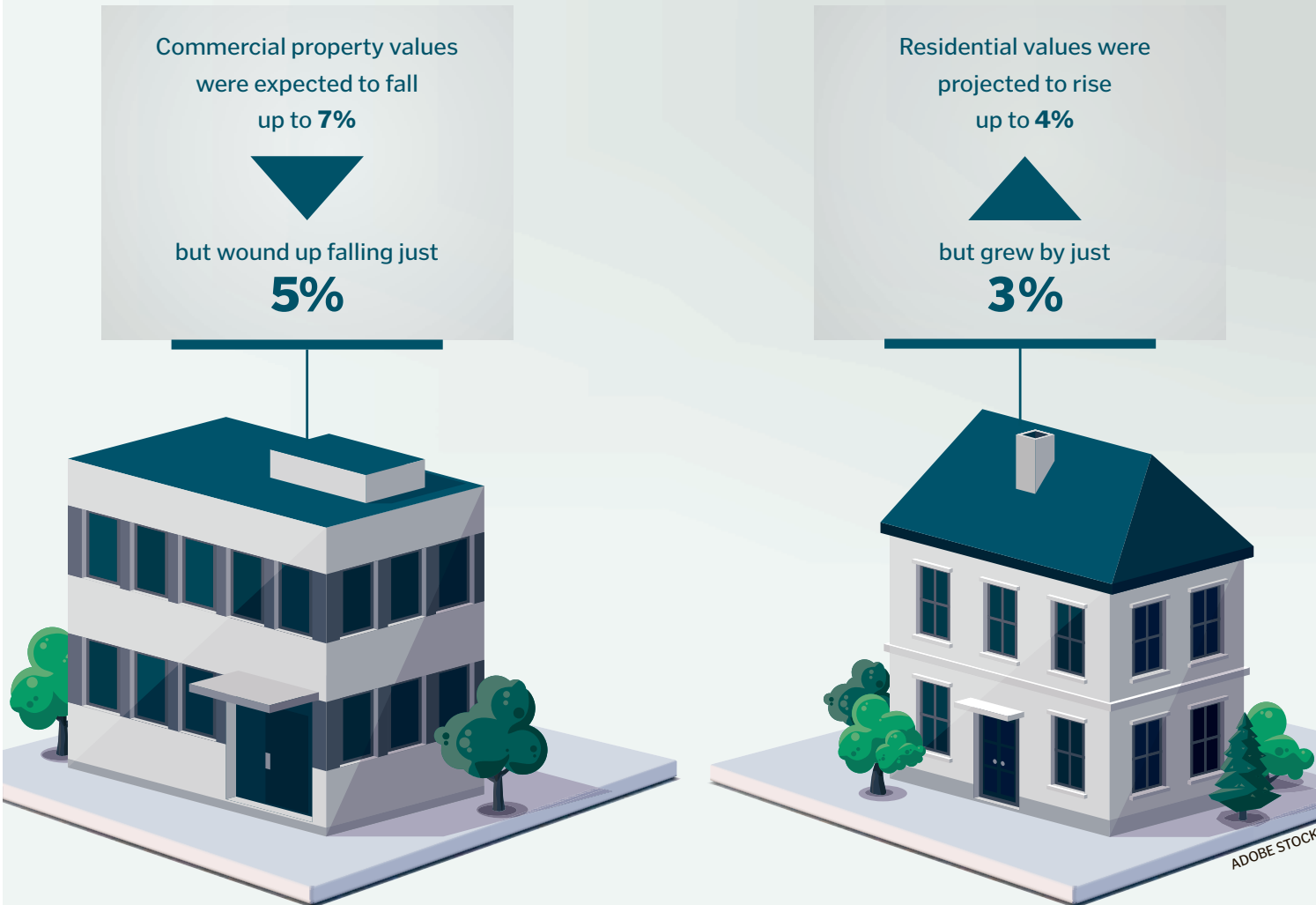
The rates were approved by a vote of the City Council, with some councilors and Mayor Michelle Wu criticizing state Senate lawmakers for killing her proposal that would have softened the tax hikes on residential owners.

Speaking on GBH’s “Ask the Mayor” Wednesday, Wu expressed frustration that some senators ultimately pulled their support for the proposal, despite having reached a compromise deal with business groups and winning the support of the City Council and lawmakers in the House of Representatives.

“We don’t have time at the city level to play games,” Wu said, issuing her first public remarks since the Senate’s top leader said the chamber would not take up the proposal that would have temporarily shifted more of the city’s property tax burden

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In the end, the numbers didn’t add up for Wu



‘Assessors treat it like it’s science, but everybody acknowledges it’s more art. It’s gotten harder to do than it once was. In periods of flux, property valuation is harder. The projections are just inherently more difficult.’

DAVID N. SCHLEICHER,
*a professor at
Yale Law School*

It’s no surprise the forecast property values were a little off. But it was enough.

By Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

How much is a city like Boston worth? The answer is a moving target. And a narrow miss just torpedoed Mayor Michelle Wu’s contentious push to boost tax rates on office buildings.

As it readied tax bills for next year, Boston’s Assessing Department this fall updated the values of some 170,500 properties, determining what each is worth and whether, together, the real estate taxes charged on those parcels will generate enough revenue to fund the bulk of Boston’s \$4.6 billion budget. It’s a dynamic process that’s difficult, if not impossible, to perfect — particularly these days, when the long-term effects of the COVID-19 pandemic on the value of commercial real estate remain a major uncertainty.

“Assessors treat it like it’s science, but everybody acknowledges it’s more art,” said David N. Schleicher, a professor at Yale Law School who studies local government. “It’s gotten harder to do than it once was. In periods of flux, property valuation is harder. The

THE NUMBERS, Page A10

Sox trade for an ace

Boston acquired 25-year-old lefthander Garrett Crochet from the White Sox for four prospects. **C1.**

Belichick goes to UNC

The longtime Patriots coach has a five-year deal to return to the game, this time at the college level with the Tar Heels. **C1.**



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Solar mates

Thursday: Sunny, breezy. High 41-46. Low 24-29.

Friday: Sunny, cooler. Sunrise: 7:04 Sunset: 4:12

Weather and Comics, D5-6. Obituaries, C9.

Temperatures reached the 60s but it wasn’t a day to get out and enjoy it, with heavy rain and high winds causing numerous problems (above, a wet Quincy Market). **B4.**

Luigi Mangione was reportedly carrying a notebook

that detailed plans for the shooting of an executive at a conference. **A2.**

Auto magnate Herb Chambers is donating \$100 million to Massachusetts General Hospital to help in the fight against cancer. **D1.**

Skeptics fear report on Worcester police won’t have much effect

Nothing in place to enforce reform recommendations

By John Hilliard and Dan Glaun
GLOBE STAFF

The report was scathing. Justice Department officials alleged Worcester police officers had sexual encounters with women they were investigating for prostitution. In other cases, they found, Worcester officers had a pattern of engaging in excessive force.

Community advocates applauded the report’s release, saying it vindicated longstanding complaints they had about Worcester police. But the advocates also raised concerns this week about the apparent limits

the Justice Department will have in enforcing recommended reforms.

The report, advocates noted, doesn’t include a consent decree, or any sort of legal agreement between investigators and city officials. No lawsuit was filed.

“I am skeptical,” said Nicole Bell-Peña, one of the women who told federal investigators she had been sexually abused by police. “It was hard for myself and so many other women to come forward and even talk about our experiences. That will all be for naught if the city doesn’t support this report and serious efforts to make these changes.”

Worcester-based attorney Hector Pineiro, who has repeatedly sued Worcester police for

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